

Chapter 14: Bilingual Clinical Role-Play Dialogues

Periodontal Disease Education & Communication (English & Spanish)

Periodontal Disease Education & Nonsurgical Therapy Communication

■ SCENARIO 1: Explaining Periodontal Pockets & Deep Scaling (SRP / NSPT)

****Clinical Context****

A patient diagnosed with Stage II Periodontitis with 4–5 mm pockets is nervous about needing "deep cleaning" (NSPT) instead of a standard regular cleaning.

****Dialogue (Bilingual)****

Dental Hygienist (English):

"During your periodontal exam, we measured 4 to 5 millimeter pockets around your back teeth, along with bleeding when we probed. A regular dental cleaning only polishes above the gumline, but bacteria and hardened calculus have moved beneath the gums where brushing cannot reach. Scaling and root planing removes those subgingival deposits and smooths the root surfaces so your gums can heal and tighten back onto the teeth."

Higienista Dental (Español):

"Durante su examen periodontal, medimos bolsas de 4 a 5 milímetros alrededor de sus muelas, junto con sangrado al sondear. Una limpieza regular solo pule por encima de la encía, pero las bacterias y el sarro endurecido se han acumulado por debajo de las encías donde el cepillo no llega. El raspado y alisado radicular elimina esos depósitos profundos y alisa las raíces para que sus encías puedan sanar y adherirse nuevamente al diente."

■ SCENARIO 2: Post-Op Care & 4–6 Week Re-evaluation Importance

****Clinical Context****

A patient completes quad scaling and asks why they must return in 4 to 6 weeks for a re-evaluation appointment.

****Dialogue (Bilingual)****

Dental Hygienist (English):

"Gingival tissues take about 4 to 6 weeks to fully heal, resolve inflammation, and form a strong new attachment against your teeth. When you return in one month, we will re-measure your pocket depths and check for bleeding to confirm that the infection is gone and ensure your bone support has stabilized."

Higienista Dental (Español):

"Los tejidos de las encías tardan entre 4 y 6 semanas en desinflamarse por completo, cicatrizar y formar una nueva unión firme contra sus dientes. Cuando regrese en un mes, volveremos a medir sus bolsas y verificaremos si hay sangrado para confirmar que la infección ha desaparecido y que el soporte óseo se ha estabilizado."